Unit 11 · There was / There were (past)

Name _____

THE BIG IDEA

There was / There were tells us what existed in the past. One thing → was. Many things → were.

There was / There were — что было в прошлом. Один предмет — was, много — were.

How we build it

WHICH	PATTERN	EXAMPLE	РУССКИЙ
One	There was + a / an + noun	**There was a park.**	Там был парк.
Many	There were + some / lots of + nouns	**There were some trains.**	Там было несколько поездов.
No	There wasn't a … · There weren't any …	**There weren't any cars.**	Там не было машин.
Question	Was there a …? · Were there any …?	**Were there any planes?**	Там были самолёты?
Answer	Yes, there was / were. · No, there wasn't / weren't.	**No, there weren't.**	Нет.

When we use it

Describe the past: There was a castle.
Описать прошлое.

Compare then and now: There weren't any phones.
Сравнить тогда и сейчас.

Ask about the past: Was there a school?
Спросить о прошлом.

REMEMBER

Time words: yesterday, last week, ago, then. The sentence is about a time that is finished.

RUSSIAN AND ENGLISH

Russian: «Там был парк» — was / were agree with the thing: one → was; two or more → were. Use some / lots of in +, any in −.

Watch out! We often say…

~~There was two trains.~~	**There were two trains.**
~~There weren't a mall.~~	**There wasn't a mall.**
~~There were some planes ago.~~	**… fifty years ago.**

EASY TRICK

Past of «there is» = «there was» · past of «there are» = «there were». Use some in +, any in − and ?.

Try it! Circle the right answer

1 There ___ a castle. (was / were)

2 There ___ two trains. (was / were)

3 There weren't ___ cars. (some / any)

4 ___ there a mall? (Was / Were)

5 Were there any planes? No, there ___. (weren't / wasn't)

6 There ___ some dogs. (was / were)

Answers: 1 was · 2 were · 3 any · 4 Was · 5 weren't · 6 were